

INTERNATIONAL CYBERSECURITY AND DIGITAL FORENSICS ACADEMY

Nasarawa State, Nigeria

ACICP 101 — Physics & Electrical Circuit Fundamentals for ICS/SCADA

Week 1 Assignment 01: Circuit-Calculation Worksheet

Lab Title:	Circuit-Calculation Worksheet (Ohm's Law, Power, Series/Parallel, 4-20 mA Scaling)
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Executive Summary

This worksheet solves the Week 1 Circuit-Calculation Assignment for ACICP 101. It covers basic Ohm's Law and power calculations, series and parallel resistor networks, 4-20 mA instrumentation scaling used in ICS/SCADA systems, and a troubleshooting calculation on a relay coil and a voltage divider. Every question is solved using the simplest classroom method: state the formula, substitute the given values, then write the final answer with its correct unit, exactly as taught on the board. All workings are shown in full as required by the assignment instructions.

Lab Objectives

To apply Ohm's Law ($V = I \times R$) to calculate current, voltage, resistance and power in simple DC circuits.

To calculate total resistance, current and power in series, parallel and mixed resistor networks.

To apply 4-20 mA current loop scaling used in ICS/SCADA instrumentation.

To calculate cable resistance and voltage drop in a field instrumentation loop.

To use calculation to troubleshoot a faulty relay coil and design a voltage divider.

Tools and Resources Used

Scientific calculator - used to carry out arithmetic and check working.

Formula sheet provided in the assignment (Ohm's Law, Power, Series, Parallel, Voltage Divider, 4-20 mA Scaling).

Pen and paper method (chalkboard style) - formula, substitution, answer.

Methodology and Solutions

Every question below is solved in three simple steps, the same way a teacher solves it on the board: (1) write the formula, (2) substitute the given numbers into the formula, (3) write the final answer with its unit. Units are written plainly (V, A, mA, ohm, kOhm, W, mW) as would be written with chalk on a board.

Part A: Basic Electrical Quantity Calculations

Question A1

A 24 V DC supply is connected to a 160 ohm load. Find current and power.

Given: $V = 24 \text{ V}$, $R = 160 \text{ ohm}$

Formula: $I = V / R$

Substitute: $I = 24 / 160$

$I = 0.15 \text{ A} = 150 \text{ mA}$

Formula: $P = V \times I$

Substitute: $P = 24 \times 0.15$

Answer: $P = 3.6 \text{ W}$

Question A2

A PLC input module draws 8 mA from a 24 V supply. Find resistance and power.

Given: $I = 8 \text{ mA} = 0.008 \text{ A}$, $V = 24 \text{ V}$

Formula: $R = V / I$

Substitute: $R = 24 / 0.008$

Answer: $R = 3000 \text{ ohm} = 3 \text{ kOh}$

Formula: $P = V \times I$

Substitute: $P = 24 \times 0.008$

Answer: $P = 0.192 \text{ W}$

Question A3

A 12 V indicator lamp is rated at 3 W. Find normal current and resistance.

Given: $V = 12 \text{ V}$, $P = 3 \text{ W}$

Formula: $I = P / V$

Substitute: $I = 3 / 12$

Answer: $I = 0.25 \text{ A} = 250 \text{ mA}$

Formula: $R = V / I$

Substitute: $R = 12 / 0.25$

Answer: $R = 48 \text{ ohm}$

Question A4

A resistor carries 75 mA and dissipates 0.45 W. Find voltage and resistance.

Given: $I = 75 \text{ mA} = 0.075 \text{ A}$, $P = 0.45 \text{ W}$

Formula: $V = P / I$

Substitute: $V = 0.45 / 0.075$

Answer: $V = 6 \text{ V}$

Formula: $R = V / I$

Substitute: $R = 6 / 0.075$

Answer: $R = 80 \text{ ohm}$

Question A5

A 0.25 W resistor is connected across 24 V. Find the minimum resistance so it is not overloaded.

Given: $P (\text{max}) = 0.25 \text{ W}$, $V = 24 \text{ V}$

Formula: $R = V^2 / P$

Substitute: $R = 24^2 / 0.25 = 576 / 0.25$

Answer: $R(\text{minimum}) = 2304 \text{ ohm}$

Note: any resistance below 2304 ohm will let the power exceed 0.25 W, so the resistor must be 2304 ohm or higher.

Part B: Series, Parallel and Mixed Networks

Question B1

120 ohm, 330 ohm and 470 ohm resistors in series across 24 V DC.

Given: $R_1 = 120 \text{ ohm}$, $R_2 = 330 \text{ ohm}$, $R_3 = 470 \text{ ohm}$, $V = 24 \text{ V}$

Formula: $R(\text{total}) = R_1 + R_2 + R_3$

Substitute: $R(\text{total}) = 120 + 330 + 470$

Answer: $R(\text{total}) = 920 \text{ ohm}$

Formula: $I = V / R(\text{total})$

Substitute: $I = 24 / 920$

Answer: $I = 0.0261 \text{ A} = 26.1 \text{ mA}$ (same current flows through all three, series circuit)

Formula: $V = I \times R$ (for each resistor)

$$V1 = 0.0261 \times 120 = 3.13 \text{ V}$$

$$V2 = 0.0261 \times 330 = 8.61 \text{ V}$$

$$V3 = 0.0261 \times 470 = 12.26 \text{ V}$$

$$\text{Check: } V1 + V2 + V3 = 3.13 + 8.61 + 12.26 = 24.0 \text{ V (equals supply, correct)}$$

Formula: $P = V \times I$ (for each resistor)

$$P1 = 3.13 \times 0.0261 = 0.082 \text{ W}$$

$$P2 = 8.61 \times 0.0261 = 0.225 \text{ W}$$

$$P3 = 12.26 \times 0.0261 = 0.320 \text{ W}$$

Question B2

240 ohm and 360 ohm loads in parallel across a 24 V supply.

Given: $R1 = 240 \text{ ohm}$, $R2 = 360 \text{ ohm}$, $V = 24 \text{ V}$

Formula: $1/R(\text{total}) = 1/R1 + 1/R2$

$$\text{Substitute: } 1/R(\text{total}) = 1/240 + 1/360 = 0.004167 + 0.002778 = 0.006944$$

$$\text{Answer: } R(\text{total}) = 1 / 0.006944 = 144 \text{ ohm}$$

Formula: $I = V / R$ (each branch, since voltage is the same across both in parallel)

$$I1 = 24 / 240 = 0.1 \text{ A} = 100 \text{ mA}$$

$$I2 = 24 / 360 = 0.0667 \text{ A} = 66.7 \text{ mA}$$

Formula: $I(\text{supply}) = I1 + I2$

$$\text{Answer: } I(\text{supply}) = 100 + 66.7 = 166.7 \text{ mA}$$

Formula: $P(\text{total}) = V \times I(\text{supply})$

$$\text{Substitute: } P(\text{total}) = 24 \times 0.1667$$

$$\text{Answer: } P(\text{total}) = 4.0 \text{ W}$$

Question B3

100 ohm resistor in series with a parallel network of 220 ohm and 330 ohm. Supply = 24 V DC.

Step 1: Find resistance of the parallel section (220 ohm and 330 ohm)

Formula: $1/R_p = 1/R_2 + 1/R_3$

Substitute: $1/R_p = 1/220 + 1/330 = 0.004545 + 0.003030 = 0.007576$

$R_p = 1 / 0.007576 = 132 \text{ ohm}$

Step 2: Find total resistance

Formula: $R(\text{total}) = R_1 + R_p$

Substitute: $R(\text{total}) = 100 + 132$

Answer: $R(\text{total}) = 232 \text{ ohm}$

Step 3: Find total current

Formula: $I(\text{total}) = V / R(\text{total})$

Substitute: $I(\text{total}) = 24 / 232$

Answer: $I(\text{total}) = 0.1034 \text{ A} = 103.4 \text{ mA}$

Step 4: Find voltage across the parallel section

Formula: $V(\text{parallel}) = I(\text{total}) \times R_p$

Substitute: $V(\text{parallel}) = 0.1034 \times 132$

Answer: $V(\text{parallel}) = 13.66 \text{ V}$

Step 5: Find the current through each branch of the parallel section

$I(220 \text{ ohm}) = V(\text{parallel}) / 220 = 13.66 / 220 = 0.0621 \text{ A} = 62.1 \text{ mA}$

$I(330 \text{ ohm}) = V(\text{parallel}) / 330 = 13.66 / 330 = 0.0414 \text{ A} = 41.4 \text{ mA}$

Check: $62.1 \text{ mA} + 41.4 \text{ mA} = 103.5 \text{ mA}$ (matches total current, small rounding)

Part C: Instrumentation and ICS/SCADA Signal Calculations

Question C1

A 4-20 mA pressure transmitter is scaled for 0-10 bar. Find the pressure at 4 mA, 8 mA, 13.6 mA, 16 mA and 20 mA.

Formula: $\text{Percent} = (I - 4) / 16 \times 100\%$, then $\text{Pressure} = \text{Percent} \times 10 \text{ bar} / 100$

(this is the same as: $\text{Pressure} = (I - 4) / 16 \times 10 \text{ bar}$)

At 4 mA: $P = (4 - 4) / 16 \times 10 = 0 \text{ bar}$

At 8 mA: $P = (8 - 4) / 16 \times 10 = (4/16) \times 10 = 2.5 \text{ bar}$

At 13.6 mA: $P = (13.6 - 4) / 16 \times 10 = (9.6/16) \times 10 = 6 \text{ bar}$

At 16 mA: $P = (16 - 4) / 16 \times 10 = (12/16) \times 10 = 7.5 \text{ bar}$

At 20 mA: $P = (20 - 4) / 16 \times 10 = (16/16) \times 10 = 10 \text{ bar}$

Question C2

A 250 ohm burden resistor converts a 4-20 mA signal to voltage. Find voltage at 4 mA, 12 mA and 20 mA.

Formula: $V = I \times R$

At 4 mA: $V = 0.004 \times 250 = 1 \text{ V}$

At 12 mA: $V = 0.012 \times 250 = 3 \text{ V}$

At 20 mA: $V = 0.020 \times 250 = 5 \text{ V}$

Question C3

Field cable has 0.055 ohm per metre per conductor. Transmitter is 180 m from the PLC. Find total loop cable resistance and voltage drop at 20 mA.

Note: a current loop needs two conductors (go and return), so total wire length = $2 \times 180 \text{ m} = 360 \text{ m}$

Formula: $R(\text{cable}) = \text{length} \times \text{resistance per metre}$

Substitute: $R(\text{cable}) = 360 \times 0.055$

Answer: $R(\text{cable}) = 19.8 \text{ ohm}$

Formula: $V(\text{drop}) = I \times R(\text{cable})$

Substitute: $V(\text{drop}) = 0.020 \times 19.8$

Answer: $V(\text{drop}) = 0.396 \text{ V}$ (approximately 0.40 V)

Question C4

PLC analogue input needs at least 11 V at the transmitter terminals. Supply = 24 V DC, burden = 250 ohm, loop current = 20 mA, cable resistance as above. Is the supply adequate?

Voltage used by burden resistor: $V(\text{burden}) = I \times R(\text{burden}) = 0.020 \times 250 = 5 \text{ V}$

Voltage used by cable: $V(\text{cable}) = 0.396 \text{ V}$ (from C3 above)

Formula: $V(\text{at transmitter}) = V(\text{supply}) - V(\text{burden}) - V(\text{cable})$

Substitute: $V(\text{at transmitter}) = 24 - 5 - 0.396$

Answer: $V(\text{at transmitter}) = 18.6 \text{ V}$

Compare: 18.6 V is greater than the required 11 V.

Conclusion: Yes, the 24 V supply is adequate for this loop.

Part D: Troubleshooting Calculation (10 marks)

Question D1

A relay coil is labelled 24 V DC, 120 ohm. Find the expected current. Measured current is only 50 mA. Find the apparent resistance and state two likely causes.

Step 1: Expected current

Formula: $I = V / R$

Substitute: $I = 24 / 120$

Answer: $I(\text{expected}) = 0.2 \text{ A} = 200 \text{ mA}$

Step 2: Apparent resistance from the measured current

Given: $I(\text{measured}) = 50 \text{ mA} = 0.05 \text{ A}$

Formula: $R(\text{apparent}) = V / I(\text{measured})$

Substitute: $R(\text{apparent}) = 24 / 0.05$

Answer: $R(\text{apparent}) = 480 \text{ ohm}$

Two likely causes of this higher resistance (lower current than expected):

1. The coil winding is partially open or damaged (burnt/broken turns), which increases its resistance.
2. A loose, corroded or dirty terminal/connection in the coil circuit is adding extra resistance in series.

Question D2

A sensor input expects 5 V from a divider supplied by 24 V. $R_2 = 5 \text{ k}\Omega$ (from output to 0 V). Find R_1 (from 24 V to output), the divider current, and power in each resistor.

Step 1: Find R_1 using the voltage divider formula

Formula: $V(\text{out}) = V(\text{in}) \times R_2 / (R_1 + R_2)$

Substitute: $5 = 24 \times 5000 / (R_1 + 5000)$

Cross multiply: $5 \times (R_1 + 5000) = 24 \times 5000$

$$5R_1 + 25000 = 120000$$

$$5R_1 = 95000$$

Answer: $R_1 = 19000 \text{ ohm} = 19 \text{ k}\Omega$

Step 2: Find divider current

Formula: $I = V(\text{in}) / (R_1 + R_2)$

Substitute: $I = 24 / (19000 + 5000) = 24 / 24000$

Answer: $I = 0.001 \text{ A} = 1 \text{ mA}$

Step 3: Find power in each resistor

Formula: $P = I^2 \times R$

$$P(R_1) = (0.001)^2 \times 19000 = 0.019 \text{ W} = 19 \text{ mW}$$

$$P(R_2) = (0.001)^2 \times 5000 = 0.005 \text{ W} = 5 \text{ mW}$$

Check: $P(\text{total}) = V \times I = 24 \times 0.001 = 0.024 \text{ W} = 19 \text{ mW} + 5 \text{ mW} = 24 \text{ mW}$ (correct)

Conclusion

All calculations in this worksheet were carried out using the basic Ohm's Law and power formulas, the series and parallel resistance rules, and the 4-20 mA scaling formula. Every answer was obtained step by step: formula first, then substitution, then final answer with its correct unit, the same simple method used on the chalkboard in class. This exercise reinforced how voltage, current, resistance and power relate to one another in simple DC circuits, in resistor networks, and in 4-20 mA instrumentation loops used in ICS/SCADA systems, and showed how calculation can be used to check whether a measured fault value (relay coil) matches the expected value.

Student Declaration

I confirm that this submission is my own work and that all sources, screenshots, simulations, and calculations used have been honestly presented.

I understand that unsafe electrical practice, copied work, or fabricated screenshots may attract disciplinary action.

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